INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: GERMANY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will understand Germany's climate, the importance of rivers, soil types, grape varieties, and learn about selected wine regions. Students will recognize the hierarchy of German wine law (Wein, Qualitätswein, Prädikatswein), and the progression of Prädikat levels.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will expand their knowledge of wine terms, label terms, history, lore, and classifications. A candidate will be able to describe the general styles of finished wine, including structure and flavors. A Certified Sommelier will know the proper ways to include the wines of Germany on a wine list, be able to recognize iconic producers, and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with these wines to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Most wine regions in Germany are located in the southwest of the corner of the country on the borders with France, Belgium and Switzerland. Northerly location: Vineyards planted at 49°N and above.	
Geography: Climate Categories	Cool Continental	
Geography: Physical Feature	**Rivers:** The Rhine River and its tributaries: High importance of moderating influence from rivers. Rivers reflect sunlight back up to the vineyards increasing warmth to aid in ripening. **Mountains:** Mountains provide protection from cold north winds and create rain shadows.	
Soil: Type and/or Name	**Mosel:** Slate **Other regions:** various soil types	
Grape Growing	Steep, south-facing hillsides maximize sun exposure and warmth. Carefully selected vineyards for successful ripening. Cool growing seasons.	
Winemaking	Large wooden fuder or stück or stainless-steel fermentation. Residual sugar often left in the wine to counterbalance acidity (not all sugars are fermented to alcohol). Alcohol in off-dry wine is generally low. Wines can be fermented dry, remain off-dry, or lusciously sweet. **Chaptalization:** The process of adding sugar to unfermented grape must in order to increase the alcohol content after fermentation. Used when grapes do not achieve sufficient sugar ripeness.	**Deutscher Sekt:** Sparkling wine made by any method from grapes grown in Germany.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	**Riesling** (most planted and most important)	Müller-Thurgau, Silvaner, Weissburgunder (Pinot Blanc), Grauburgunder (Pinot Gris)
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	**Spätburgunder** (Pinot Noir)	

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law / Classification		
	Wines without Geographic Indication:	
	Deutscher Wein	
	Wines with Geographic Indication:	
	Landwein - Regional Wines	
	Qualitätswein:	
	Quality wine from one of the 13 major wine regions called Anbaugebiete.	
	Prädikatswein (prädikat means "distinction"):	
	Subset of Qualitätswein categorized by ripeness (ripeness = level of sugar in the grapes) at harvest. Considered the highest quality level for wines with residual sugar. Chaptalization is not allowed. **Six prädikate (levels of quality):** Recognize these styles in order of ripeness. Understand the general styles of the finished wines and typical level of sweetness. Understand these designations are categorized by ripeness at harvest, however choices made in the winery will determine finished sweetness of the wine.	
	1. Kabinett: off-dry in style, can also be made trocken (dry)	
	2. Spätlese: off-dry in style, can also be made trocken (dry)	
	3. Auslese: often off-dry in style, can sometimes be made trocken (dry)	
	4. Beerenauslese: very sweet in style, often affected by botrytis.	
	5. Eiswein: very sweet in style, grapes must be frozen. No effects of botrytis. ****same ripeness-level as Beerenauslese***	
	6. Trockenbeerenauslese: very sweet in style	

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Wine Law / Classification		**VDP - Verband Deutscher Pradikatsweingüter:** National German association of producers committed to traditional quality winemaking**.** Developed their own classification system on Burgundy model with classified top vineyard sites. **Recognize VDP logo.** **Grosses Gewächs:** Single Vineyard Grand Cru Wines **Erstes Gewächs:** Single Vineyard Premier Cru Wines
General Terms	**Anbaugebiete:** One of 13 wine growing areas/regions.	**Gemeinde:** Local community or village
	Prädikate: Quality levels based on ripeness at harvest (Kabinett, Spätlese etc.).	**Einzellage:** Single vineyard
		Oechsle Scale: The German scale used to measure must weight.
		Bocksbeutel: Unique, flattened ellipsoid wine bottle specific to the Franken Anbaugebiete.
Label Terms	**Trocken:** Dry	**Halbtrocken:** Half-dry
		Edelfäule: Noble rot (botrytis)
		Schloss: German word for castle, similar to the French word for château.

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law / Appellations	**Important Anbaugebiete of Germany**	**Important Anbaugebiete of Germany**
	Mosel Along the Mosel River. Soil: Slate that is porous and heat-retaining South-facing vineyards to capture warmth of the sun. Grape Variety: Riesling ***Recognize major villages on a map as being part of the Mosel:** Erden, Ürzig, Wehlen, Bernkastel-Kues, Piesport*	**Nahe:** Nahe River is a tributary of the Rhine. Continental Climate Grape Variety: Riesling
	Pfalz Continuation of Alsace, mountain protection, Rhein River moderates climate. One of the warmest areas in Germany, focus is on dry wines. Grape Varieties: Riesling, Spätburgunder	**Franken:** Located along the Main river near Frankfurt. White Grape Varieties: Silvaner Red Grape Varieties: Spätburgunder Special bottle shape called a Bocksbeutel
	Rheinhessen The largest Anbaugebiete in size and production volume. Rhein River Grape Varieties: Riesling	**Baden** Covers a large area along the French and Swiss borders. Warmest growing area. Main Grape Varieties: Spätburgunder, Müller Thurgau
	Rheingau Mountains protect the region from the cold north. Long, south-facing slope facing the Rhein River Rhein River (moderates and reflects light) Climate: Continental Grape Varieties: Riesling, Spätburgunder *Recognize **Johannisberg** as a major village on a map of the Rheingau.	**Mittelrhein** Steep slopes along the Rhein River Climate: Continental Main Grape Variety: Riesling Slate Soil
		Ahr Ahr River One of Germany's smallest and most northerly winegrowing regions, north of the 50th parallel. Main Grape Variety: Spätburgunder (some of the best in Germany)
Producer/Proprietary Brand		**Nahe:** Hermann Dönnhoff **Franken:** Hans Wirsching **Rheingau:** Franz Künstler, Robert Weil, Josef Leitz **Rheinhessen:** Gunderloch **Mosel:** Fritz Haag, Dr. Loosen, Egon Müller, Joh. Jos. Prüm, Selbach-Oster

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Vintage		
History & Lore		**1971 German Wine Law** Stipulated ripeness level at harvest as the prime determinant for quality. Established the top two categories of wine QBA and QMP.
Service of Beverage		Know styles and sweetness levels and where each belongs on a wine list and appropriate serving temperatures.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Pairings with both sweet and dry Riesling.
Business of the Sommelier		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: AUSTRIA

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to identify and locate major Austrian wine regions and appellations. A student will understand important geographic features, major grape varieties, and how Austrian wines differ from German wines.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will increase their knowledge of general terms, styles of wine, and classifications in Austria. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with Austrian Grüner Veltliner to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Eastern Austria	
Geography: Climate Categories	Continental	Some Mediterranean climates (warm air from the east)
Geography: Physical Features	Foothills of the Alps Mountains Danube River	
Soil: Type and/or Name		
Grape Growing	Steep hillsides overlooking the Danube River and its tributaries.	
Winemaking	Very dry or very sweet white wine, no current production of off-dry styles. New oak is rarely used for white wine production.	
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Grüner Veltliner	Riesling
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names		Zweigelt, Blaufränkisch
Wine Law / Classification	**Wines Without Geographical Indication:** Wein **Wines With Geographical Indication:** **Landwein:** Regional wines, rarely exported **Qualitätswein** **DAC (Districtus Austriae Controllatus):** Quality Wine/Appellation of Origin, similar to AOC or DOC system, specific grape varieties and styles are permitted, the focus is on dry wines. **Prädikatswein:** Like Germany but rarely produced in Austria.	
Wine Law / Classification	**Wachau has its own classification system based on grape ripeness at harvest.** **Example:** **Smaragd:** Highest level of ripeness, named for green lizards in the vineyards.	**Wachau Classification Levels:** ***From the least ripe to most ripe*** **Steinfeder:** Named for the feathery grass grown in the area. **Federspiel:** An ancient term for a tool used in falconry. **Smaragd:** Highest level of ripeness, named for green lizards in the vineyards.

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Subject Name: AUSTRIA

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law / Appellations	**Region:** Niederösterreich (Lower Austria) **Sub-Regions of Niederösterreich:** - Kamptal DAC - Kremstal DAC - Wachau DAC	**Regions:** **- Burgenland** - Mittelburgenland **- Steiermark (Styria)** **- Wein** **- Niederösterreich** **- Kremstal DAC:** Along the Krems River (tributary to the Danube). Dry whites from Grüner Veltliner and Riesling. **- Kamptal DAC:** Along the Kampt River (a tributary of the Danube). Dry whites using Grüner Veltliner and Riesling. **- Wachau DAC:** Dry whites from Grüner Veltliner and Riesling. Located along the Danube River. ***Vinea Wachau "Codex Wachau" Wachau has another separate classification system based on ripeness/natural alcohol potential.***
Label Terms	Recognize an Austrian wine capsule.	**Banderole:** The name for the Austrian wine capsule indicating the wine *Qualitätswein* level or higher.
Style		
General Terms		
Producer/Proprietary Brand		Emmerich Knoll, Rudi Pichler, FX Pichler, Prager, Schloss Gobelsberg, Bründlmayer
Vintage		
History & Lore		
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing		Grüner Veltliner is an unoaked, crisp, dry white wine. Its purity of flavor is great with fresh seafood, smoked fish, fresh vegetables, dishes with fresh herbs. It is a great contrast to fresh cheeses, schnitzel, and hard-to-pair foods like asparagus and artichokes.
Business of the Sommelier		

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Subject Name: HUNGARY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to recognize Tokaji as a wine from Hungary and one of the great sweet wines of the world.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a student will understand Tokaji's grape growing and winemaking. A Certified Sommelier will be able to sell and recommend food pairings with Tokaji to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Hungary is located east of Austria.	
Geography: Climate Categories		Moderate Continental
Geography: Physical Feature		Bodrog River creates humidity in Tokaj.
Soil: Type and/or Name		
Grape Growing	Botrytis-affected grapes	**Puttonyos:** The name of the basket in which the aszú grapes were traditionally gathered. **Aszú:** Shrivelled and botrytis-affected berries.
Winemaking	Sweet wine making	
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Furmint (white)	Furmint and Hárslevelű
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names		
Wine Law / Appellation	Tokaj	
Label Terms		**Eszencia:** made entirely of Aszú berries.
General Terms		
Style		
Classification		
Producer/Proprietary Brands		Royal Tokaji
Vintage		
History & Lore		Tokaji was not made during the communist years between World War II from 1949 to 1989.
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing		Foie gras, blue cheese, orchard tarts
BOS		Tokaji bottles are normally 500ml (17oz).

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: GREECE - *CERTIFIED SOMMELIER EXAM ONLY*

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know the location, climate, and grape varieties of three important wine regions of Greece. Certified Sommeliers will recognize iconic producers and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with wines from Greece to a guest.

	Certified Sommelier Exam ONLY
Geography: Location	Greece is located in Southern Europe between the Aegean Sea and the Ionian Sea.
Wine Law / Appellation	Santorini PDO Naoussa PDO Nemea PDO
Geography: Climate Categories	**Santorini PDO:** Warm Mediterranean **Naoussa PDO:** Continental
Geography: Physical Feature	**Santorini:** Located in the Aegean Sea, salt air influence
Soil: Type and/or Name	**Santorini:** Volcanic
Grape Growing	**Santorini:** Grapes are grown in the shape of baskets to protect them from intense Aegean winds.
Winemaking	
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	**Santorini PDO:** Assyrtiko
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	**Naoussa PDO:** Xinomavro **Nemea PDO:** Agiorgitiko
Wine Law	
Label Terms	
General Terms	
Style	
Classification	
Producer	**Santorini:** Sigalas
Vintage	
History & Lore	
Service of Beverage	
Food and Beverage Pairing	**Santorini Assyrtiko** is a classic white wine with intense acidity and minerality. Pairs well with seafood, roasted fish and fresh cheeses. **Naoussa Xinomavro:** Bold red wine that is often oak aged. Needs meat or animal fat such as lamb and beef to pair well to tame the rich tannins.
Business of the Sommelier	